

Global CO₂ Emissions

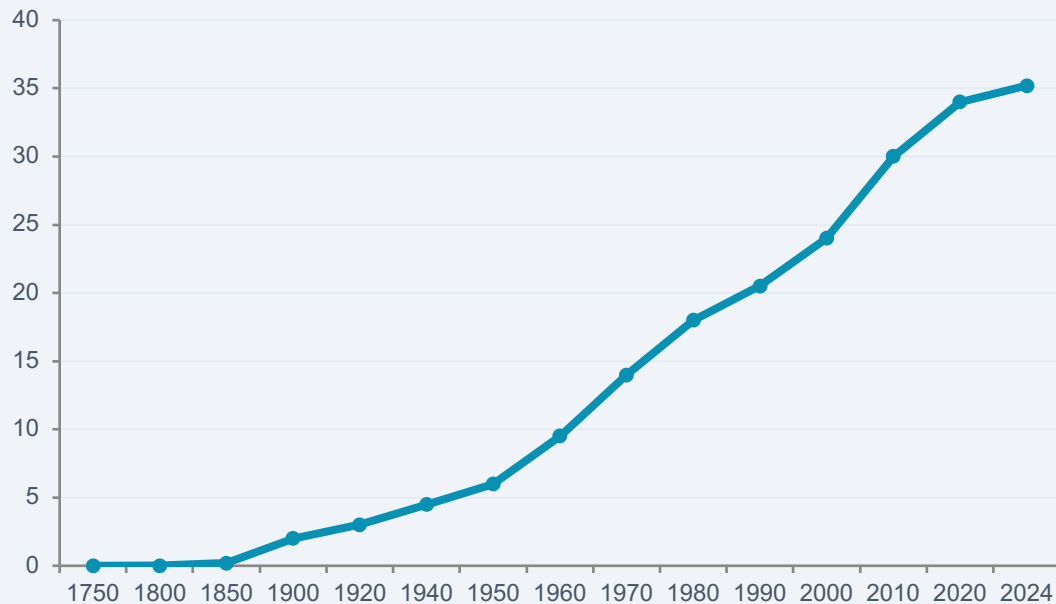
Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

Fossil Fuels & Industry | 1750–2024

Data: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

For policy analysts, climate negotiators & sustainability researchers

Global CO₂ Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today



Key Inflection Points

Pre-1850

Negligible emissions

1950

~6 Bt/yr — post-war boom

1990

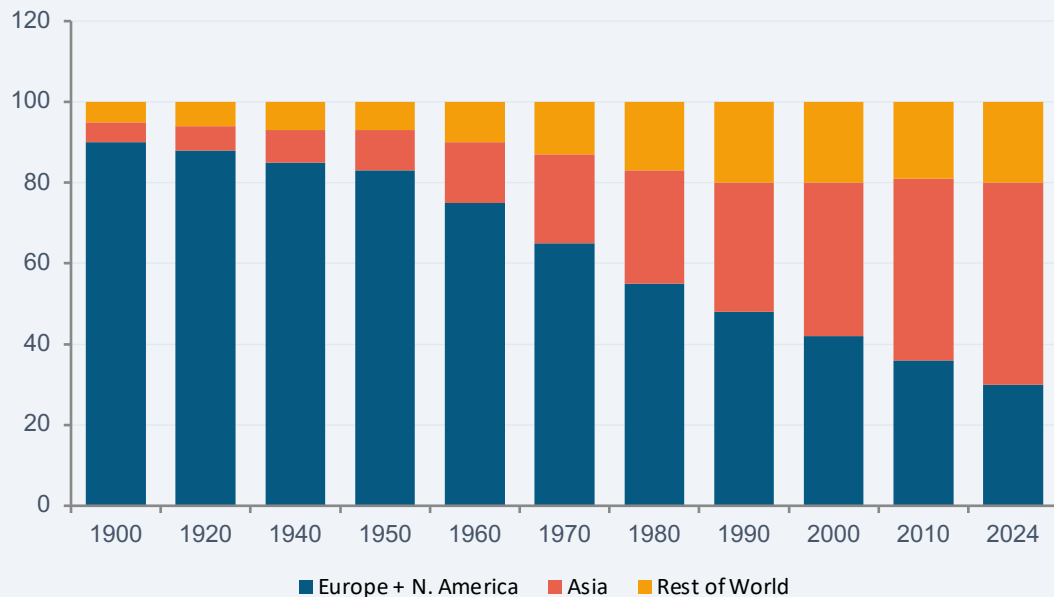
~20 Bt/yr — 4× in 40 yrs

2024

>35 Bt/yr — no peak yet

Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Third Today



1900

Europe + US = >90%

Asia = ~5%

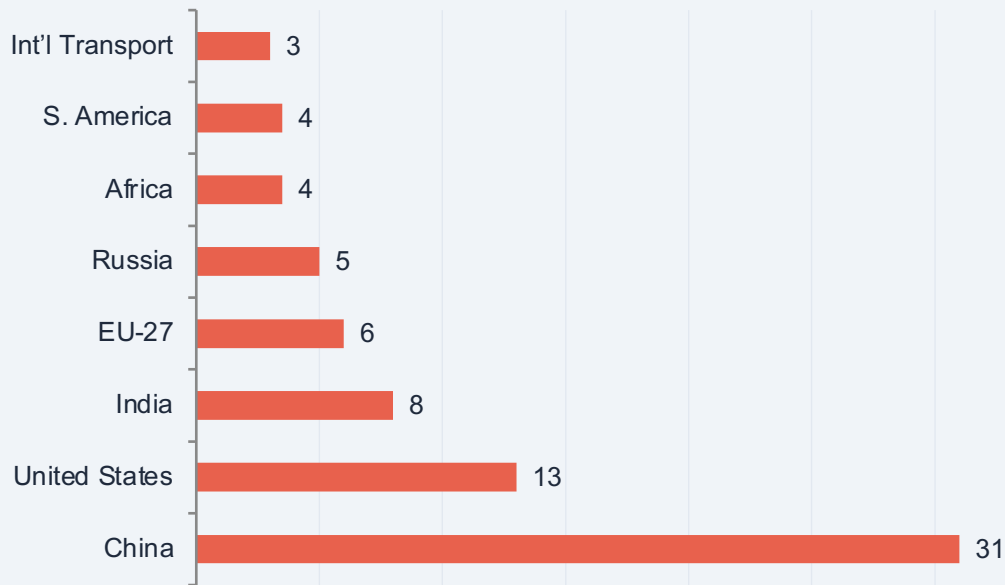
2024

Europe + US = <1/3

Asia = ~50%

Asia's rise, led by China, reshapes climate responsibility debates

China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO₂



China: 31%

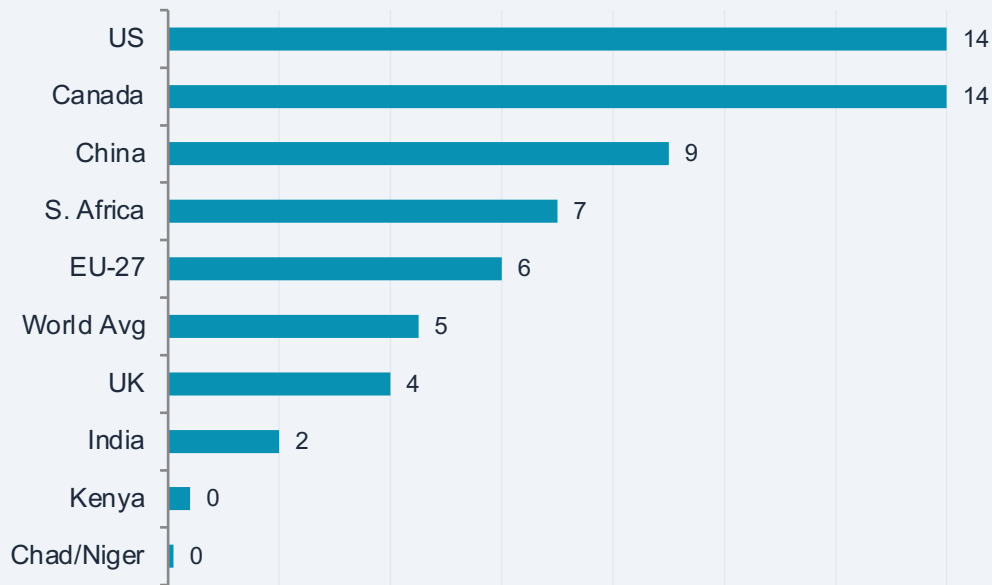
of global CO₂ emissions

More than US + India + EU combined (27%)

Trends

- China: Rising, growth slowing
- US: Declining share
- India: Rising rapidly
- EU-27: Declining
- Africa/S. America: 3–4% each

Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Canada



150× gap

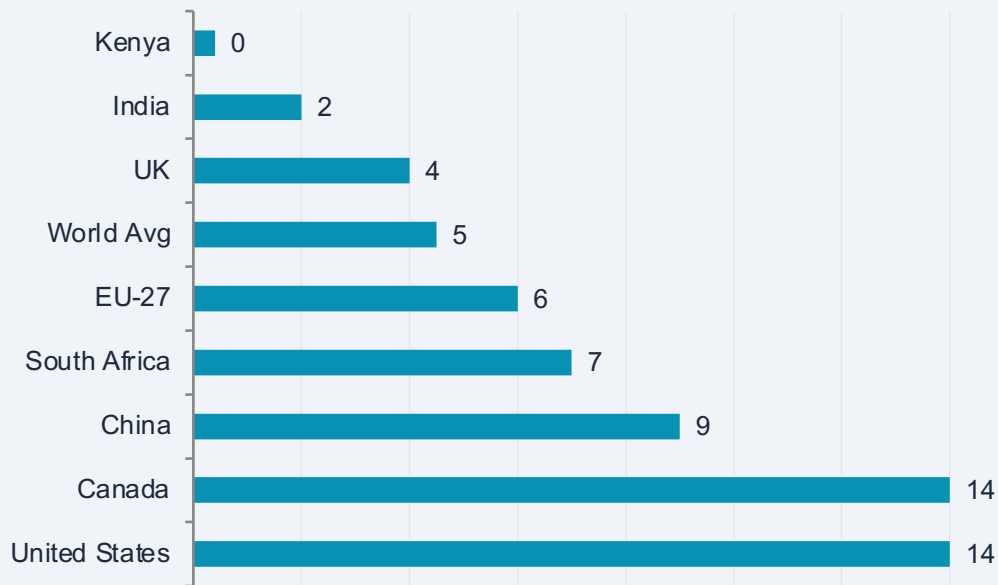
between lowest and highest emitters

An American emits in 2 days what a person in Chad emits in a year

Key Context

- Oil producers (Qatar, UAE) have even higher per capita rates
- US/Canada/Australia: ~3× global average
- France/UK lower than US at similar living standards

Per Capita Emissions Vary Widely: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2 t in India



China vs. US

Largest total emitter, but per capita (~9 t) well below the US (~14 t)

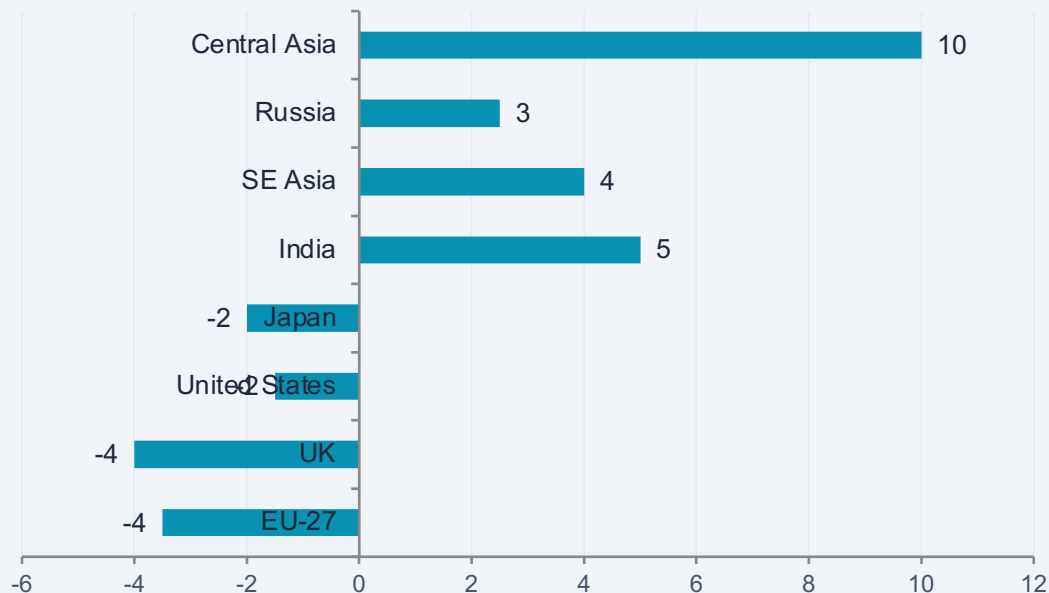
India's Low Baseline

~2 t/person — far below the world average of ~4.5 t

World Avg: 4.5 t/person

Half the listed countries fall below this line

2024 Snapshot: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions While Parts of Asia and Africa Grew



Reading This Chart

Negative (left) = declined
Positive (right) = grew

Declines in 2024

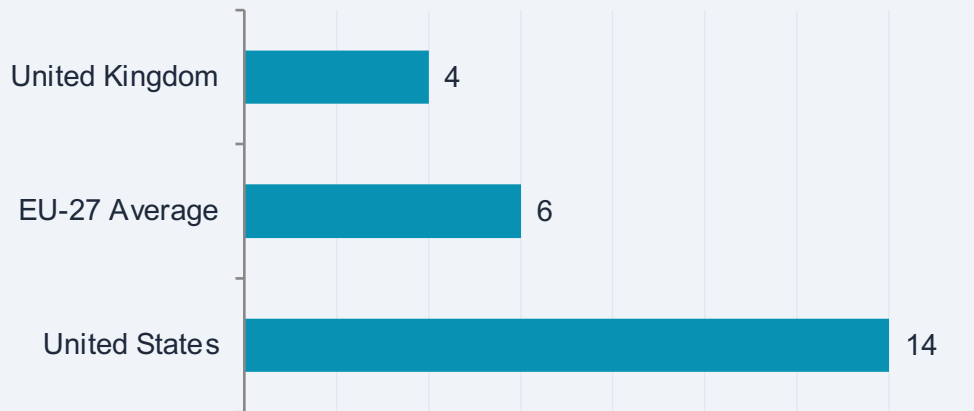
US, EU, UK, Japan — renewables & efficiency

Increases in 2024

Russia, SE Asia, Africa, Central Asia (>10%)

Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data | Approximate figures for illustrative comparison

Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Than Germany or the US



Same Prosperity, Different Emissions

Among wealthy nations, per capita emissions vary significantly due to energy mix:

Lower emitters

France, UK, Portugal — nuclear & renewables

Higher emitters

Germany, Netherlands, US — coal & gas

Energy policy and technology choices can decouple prosperity from emissions — nuclear and renewables offer a proven pathway.

Key Takeaways: Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

1

No Peak Yet

Global emissions exceed 35 Bt/yr and haven't peaked — growth has slowed but continues

2

China Leads in Totals

China is the largest annual emitter (~31%) but per capita remains below the US

3

Historical Responsibility

Europe and the US dominated emissions historically (>90% in 1900) but now <1/3

4

150× Per Capita Gap

Stark inequality: US ~14 t vs. Chad ~0.1 t per person per year

5

Policy Can Decouple

Energy mix choices (nuclear, renewables) decouple prosperity from emissions